eSIMSeeker — Complete Design Document & Cursor Build Guide

Version: 1.0 | **Author:** eSIMSeeker Design Team | **Status:** Ready for Development

> ***How to use this in Cursor:*** *Save this file as* `DESIGN.md` *in your project root. Reference it with* `@DESIGN.md` *in your Cursor prompt to give the AI full context on every page, component, and design decision before generating any code.*

---

1. Project Overview

eSIMSeeker is a minimalist, AI-powered eSIM comparison platform. Travellers describe their trip in a conversational chat interface, and the AI recommends the top 3 eSIM plans from a live catalogue of 500+ options across providers including Airalo, Holafly, Nomad, and eSIM Go. Revenue is generated exclusively through affiliate commissions. The design philosophy prioritises trust, simplicity, and conversion — in that order.

---

2. Design Principles

The entire site must adhere to four non-negotiable design principles. **Minimalism** means every element on screen must earn its place; if it doesn't guide the user toward a plan purchase, it should be removed. **Trust** means the site must look and feel like a credible, independent resource — not a spam affiliate farm. This is achieved through transparent affiliate disclosure, clean typography, and a professional "About Us" page. **Performance** means every page must load in under 1.2 seconds on a mobile connection, which dictates the use of Server Components, edge caching, and no heavy client-side JavaScript on SEO pages. **Conversion** means the path from landing to clicking an affiliate link must be as short as possible — ideally three interactions: destination input, data preference selection, plan click.

---

3. Brand Tokens (Tailwind Config)

Register these in `tailwind.config.ts` before writing any component code.

```
// tailwind.config.ts
colors: {
  brand: {
    red:    '#C0392B',  // Primary CTA, logo mark
    navy:   '#0A192F',  // Headings, footer background
    teal:   '#20B2AA',  // Active states, AI highlights
    paper:  '#F8F9FA',  // Page backgrounds, light sections
    slate:  '#E2E8F0',  // Body text on dark backgrounds
    muted:  '#A0AEC0',  // Captions, labels
  }
}
```

---

4. Site Architecture

The site is organised into three functional zones, each with a distinct purpose.

Zone	Purpose	Pages
The Funnel	Primary conversion path	`/`, `/wizard`
The SEO Engine	Organic traffic capture	`/destinations`, `/esim/[country]`, `/esim/[region]`
Trust & Legal	Legitimacy and compliance	`/about`, `/contact`, `/faq`, `/privacy`, `/terms`, `/affiliate-disclosure`

---

5. Page-by-Page Specifications

5.1 Homepage (`/`)

Purpose: Convert visitors into Wizard users. The homepage is not a brochure — it is a funnel entry point.

Sections (in order):

#	Section	Component	Key Details
1	Navigation	`<Navbar>`	Logo left, nav links centre, `Find My eSIM` CTA button right (brand-red). Sticky on scroll.
2	Hero	`<Hero>`	H1: “Find the Perfect eSIM in 30 Seconds.” Inline chat input. 3 quick-reply destination chips. Provider logo strip below.
3	How It Works	`<HowItWorks>`	3-column layout. Steps: Chat → Compare → Connect. Icon + title + 2-line description per step.
4	Popular Destinations	`<DestinationGrid>`	3×2 grid of country cards. Each card: flag, country name, plan count. Links to `/esim/[country]`.
5	Trust Banner	`<TrustBanner>`	Full-width light grey band. “Trusted by 10,000+ travellers.” 5-star rating. One testimonial quote.
6	Footer	`<Footer>`	Dark navy. 4 columns: Logo+tagline, Nav links, Legal links, Newsletter signup.

Hero Component Detail: The chat input in the hero is not a full wizard — it is a single-field entry point. When the user types a destination and presses Enter (or clicks the send button), they are navigated to `/wizard?destination=[value]` with the destination pre-populated. The quick-reply chips (e.g., “Japan”, “Thailand”, “Europe”) do the same thing on click.

5.2 AI Wizard (`/wizard`)

Purpose: The primary conversion engine. Guide the user to a plan purchase in under 60 seconds.

Layout: Split-screen on desktop (chat left, results right). Single-column stacked on mobile (results appear below chat after plans are found).

Sections:

#	Section	Component	Key Details
1	Minimal Nav	`<WizardNav>`	Logo only on left. “Back to Home” text link on right. No other distractions.
2	Chat Panel	`<ChatPanel>`	Scrollable chat history. AI bubbles left-aligned (light grey bg). User bubbles right-aligned (navy bg, white text). Quick-reply chips after each AI question. Text input + send button at bottom.
3	Results Panel	`<ResultsPanel>`	Appears once AI has extracted destination + duration + data preference. Shows top 3 `<PlanCard>` components. “See all X plans” link below.
4	Trust Bar	`<TrustBar>`	Slim full-width footer bar. Affiliate disclosure text. Info icon linking to `/affiliate-disclosure` .

PlanCard Component Detail:

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────┐
| [Provider Logo]  Plan Name        [Badge]  |
| ──────────────────────────────────────────|
| 10 GB Data  |  14 Days  |  $18.00         |
| ──────────────────────────────────────────|
| ✦ Why this fits you: Perfect for moderate  |
|   data use in Japan for 2 weeks.           |
| ──────────────────────────────────────────|
|          [ Get This Plan → ]               |
└──────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Badges: `Best Value` (dark navy bg), `Best Speed` (teal bg), `Most Data` (grey bg).

5.3 Country Landing Page (`/esim/[country]`)

Purpose: Rank for "[Country] eSIM" keywords. Convert organic search traffic into Wizard users or direct affiliate clicks.

Sections:

#	Section	Component	Key Details
1	Nav	`<Navbar>`	Same as homepage.
2	Page Hero	`<PageHero>`	Breadcrumb. H1: "Best eSIM Plans for Country". Subheadline with plan count. 3 stat badges: plan count, lowest price, network type. CTA: "Let AI Pick My Plan".
3	Filter Bar	`<FilterBar>`	Dropdowns: Duration, Data, Provider, Sort By. Reset Filters link.
4	Comparison Table	`<PlanTable>`	Columns: Provider, Data, Duration, Price, Network, Rating, Action. Sortable. "Best Value" badge on top row. "View Plan" button (affiliate link) in Action column.
5	AI Upsell Banner	`<AIBanner>`	Light terracotta-tinted band. Robot icon. "Not sure? Let our AI recommend." CTA: "Chat with AI" → `/wizard?destination=[country]`.
6	SEO Content	`<SEOContent>`	Two-column text. Left: "About eSIMs in [Country]" (3 paragraphs). Right: "How to Activate Your eSIM in [Country]" (numbered steps).
7	Footer	`<Footer>`	Same as homepage.

Rendering Strategy:

- Top 50 countries: `generateStaticParams` (pre-rendered at build time).
- Remaining 150+ countries: `dynamicParams = true`, `revalidate = 86400` (on-demand + 24h cache).

5.4 Destinations Hub (`/destinations`)

Purpose: SEO directory page and internal linking hub.

Sections:

#	Section	Component	Key Details
1	Nav	`<Navbar>`	Same as homepage.
2	Page Hero	`<PageHero>`	H1: “eSIM Plans for Every Destination”. Country search input.
3	Region Filter Tabs	`<RegionTabs>`	Pills: All, Asia, Europe, Americas, Middle East, Africa, Oceania. Active pill: navy fill.
4	Country Grid	`<CountryGrid>`	4-column grid. Each card: flag, country name, plan count. “Load All Countries” button.
5	Popular Regions	`<RegionCards>`	3-column. Region name, short description, “Browse Plans” link.
6	Footer	`<Footer>`	Same as homepage.

5.5 About Us (`/about`)

Purpose: Establish credibility and satisfy Google’s E-E-A-T (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness) requirements.

Sections:

#	Section	Key Details
1	Page Hero	H1: “Built by Travellers, for Travellers.” Origin story subheadline.
2	Our Mission	Two-column: team/travel photo left, 3 paragraphs of mission text right.
3	Affiliate Disclosure	Full-width light grey band. Handshake icon. Transparent explanation of the commission model. “Affiliate Disclosure” badge.
4	How We Rank Plans	3-column criteria cards: Real-Time Pricing, Network Coverage Data, User Reviews.
5	The Team	3-column grid of team member cards (avatar, name, title).
6	Footer	Same as homepage.

5.6 Contact (`/contact`)

Purpose: Provide a legitimate support channel and satisfy Google's trust signals.

Layout: Two-column. Contact form on the left, contact info blocks on the right.

Form Fields: Name, Email, Subject (dropdown), Message (textarea), Submit button.

Contact Info Blocks: Email address, Response time, Coverage note.

Below form: FAQ shortcut banner linking to `/faq`.

5.7 FAQ (`/faq`)

Purpose: Reduce support load and capture "eSIM how to" search queries.

Sections: Page hero with search input. Category filter pills (All, eSIM Basics, Compatibility, Activation, Billing). Accordion list of 20+ questions. "Still have questions?" CTA block at the bottom.

---

6. Component Library

All components use Shadcn/UI as the base. The following custom components must be built.

Component	File Path	Description
`<Navbar>`	`components/layout/Navbar.tsx`	Sticky top navigation with logo, links, and CTA.
`<WizardNav>`	`components/layout/WizardNav.tsx`	Minimal nav for the Wizard page.
`<Footer>`	`components/layout/Footer.tsx`	Dark navy footer with 4-column layout.
`<Hero>`	`components/marketing/Hero.tsx`	Homepage hero with inline chat input.
`<ChatPanel>`	`components/wizard/ChatPanel.tsx`	Scrollable chat interface with AI/user bubbles.
`<ResultsPanel>`	`components/wizard/ResultsPanel.tsx`	Live results panel with plan cards.
`<PlanCard>`	`components/wizard/PlanCard.tsx`	Individual plan result card with affiliate CTA.
`<PlanTable>`	`components/plans/PlanTable.tsx`	Sortable comparison table for country pages.
`<FilterBar>`	`components/plans/FilterBar.tsx`	Filter dropdowns for country pages.
`<AIBanner>`	`components/marketing/AIBanner.tsx`	AI upsell banner for country pages.
`<TrustBanner>`	`components/marketing/TrustBanner.tsx`	Social proof banner for homepage.
`<TrustBar>`	`components/wizard/TrustBar.tsx`	Slim affiliate disclosure bar.
`<CountryGrid>`	`components/destinations/CountryGrid.tsx`	Filterable grid of country cards.
`<RegionTabs>`	`components/destinations/RegionTabs.tsx`	Region filter pill tabs.

Component	File Path	Description
`<PageHero>`	`components/layout/PageHero.tsx`	Reusable slim text-only page hero with breadcrumb.
`<SEOContent>`	`components/seo/SEOContent.tsx`	Two-column SEO text block for country pages.
`<FAQAccordion>`	`components/faq/FAQAccordion.tsx`	Searchable, categorised accordion FAQ list.

---

7. Mobile Responsiveness Rules

Breakpoint	Layout Change
`sm` (640px)	Single column. Nav collapses to hamburger menu.
`md` (768px)	Two-column layouts activate (e.g., About page mission section).
`lg` (1024px)	Wizard split-screen activates. 3-column grids activate.
`xl` (1280px)	Max content width capped at `max-w-7xl` with `mx-auto`.

Mobile-Specific Wizard Behaviour: On mobile, the Results Panel renders below the Chat Panel (not side-by-side). When the AI triggers plan results, the page auto-scrolls down to the Results Panel.

---

8. SEO Requirements

Every page must include the following metadata, generated dynamically for country pages.

```
// Example for country pages
export async function generateMetadata({ params }) {
  return {
    title: `Best eSIM Plans for ${country.name} (${year}) — eSIMSeeker`,
    description: `Compare ${planCount} eSIM data plans for ${country.name}
from Airalo, Holafly, Nomad and more. From $${lowestPrice}. Updated daily.`,
    openGraph: { ... },
    alternates: { canonical: `https://esimseeker.com/esim/${params.country}`
},
  };
}
```

Additionally, every country page must include a `JSON-LD` structured data block of type `ItemList` listing the top 5 plans. This enables rich results in Google Search.

---

9. Wireframe Reference Index

The following wireframe images are located in the `/wireframes` directory of this project and correspond directly to the page specifications above.

Wireframe File	Page	URL
`wireframe_01_homepage.png`	Homepage	`/`
`wireframe_02_wizard.png`	AI Wizard	`/wizard`
`wireframe_03_country_page.png`	Country Landing Page	`/esim/[country]`
`wireframe_04_destinations.png`	Destinations Hub	`/destinations`
`wireframe_05_about.png`	About Us	`/about`
`wireframe_06_contact_faq.png`	Contact + FAQ (combined)	`/contact` , `/faq`